

Painting it Wrong

M.F. Husain has made it very clear in his recent interviews that his decision to become a Qatar citizen is mainly commercial, a fact the so-called forward thinking and secular lot in the country does not mention ("The Artist Outcast", March 15). They are all out to blame Indian fundamentalists. They see red at the very mention of Taslima Nasrin or Salman Rushdie. Have they committed a bigger crime than Husain who paints Hindu goddesses nude and in erotic positions? Unfortunately, Hindu sentiments are a doormat for anybody and everybody to trample on.

K.V. MENON,
Thiruvananthapuram

Right Act

The only remedy to the partial enactment of bills is to have a time limit, say 15 days, for getting formal assent of the President to a Bill passed by Parliament ("Acts of Omission", March 15). Another 15 days could be used for the necessary government notification for actual implementation of the Act duly legislated by Parliament. Any lapse should be taken as contempt of Parliament.

SUBHASH AGRAWAL, Delhi

Star Wars

It is irrational to blame Mammooty and Mohanlal for the current predicament of Thilakan ("Sniping

Superstars", March 15). The Association of Malayalam Movie Artistes is trying its best for a possible reconciliation, but Thilakan is in no mood to relent. There should be harmony in the film fraternity in order to enrich Malayalam cinema. Any political interference or mediation will only complicate matters.

K.V. RAGHURAM, Wayanad

has crept in. The Centre as well as the state should talk to the ULFA leaders with or without the participation of commander-in-chief Paresh Barua.

LT-COL (RETD) RANJIT SINHA,
Kochi

Tough Stand

Home Minister P. Chidambaram's tough stand on the Maoist menace has begun to unnerve them ("Raising

PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR/www.indiatodayimages.com



“Widespread indifference to family planning is a combination of pseudo-rationality and ignorance. The Government's message on family planning has failed to reach the grassroots level.”

BISHAN SAHAI, via www.indiatoday.in

Far from Peace

Most North-eastern states, including Assam, have become melting points of political upheavals ("A Hard Road to Peace", March 8). The immaturity of the state politicians as well as lack of coordinated care from the Central leadership has given birth to ULFA. As a result, development initiatives in these states have suffered and a sense of insecurity

a Red Flag", March 8). The Maoists offered a 72-day conditional ceasefire while he challenged them to give up violence for 72 hours and promised that the Government would find a solution. However, the fact that some of the Naxal-affected states are not cooperating coupled with a lack of well-trained policemen has been a source of weakness. H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA,
Mysore

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

MAY 16-31, 1980

The Chamber of Horrors

Some of the sordid truth about life inside Delhi's Tihar Jail is out again. Stories of a grim existence behind the high walls of India's premier prison have been in circulation for long but neither the bureaucrats nor the judiciary have been moved to much action. Tales of gross corruption among jail officials, widespread drug peddling, liquor smuggling and brutal living conditions have somehow won less notice than the long list of Tihar's celebrated occupants—from professional criminals to political survivors. Last September, the Supreme Court was roused into action as it perused a petition from a prisoner in Tihar relating a bizarre instance of torture inflicted upon another by a jail warder. The jail warder, wrote Sunil Batra who is under death sentence for robbing a bank van, accosted a prisoner called Prem Chand and "inserted a baton-like stick in the anus of the prisoner along with chilli powder". The act of grotesque savagery, said Batra, was "not the first incident of its kind and such cruelty, if not common, is frequent..."

by Sunil Sethi



SUNIL
BATRA

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

E-MAIL YOUR LETTERS TO: letters.editor@intoday.com

FAX THEM TO: 011-23316180

OR LOG ON TO: www.indiatoday.in